

Comfort, comfort, O my people

Text: Johannes Olearius, 1671
tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1863
GENEVA 42 (FREU DICH SEHR) 87.87.77.88

Music: Louis Bourgeois, 1551

arr. Claude Goudimel, 1565

The musical score is written on a single staff in G major (one sharp) and 12/4 time. It consists of four systems of music, each with a vocal line and three lines of lyrics. The first system begins with a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 12/4 time signature. The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a final whole note chord at the end of the first system. The lyrics are: '1 Com - fort, com - fort, O my peo - ple, speak of peace, now says our God. 2 Hark, the voice of one who's cry - ing in the des - ert far and near, 3 O make straight what long was crook - ed, make the rough - er plac - es plain.' The second system continues the melody and lyrics: 'Com - fort those who sit in dark - ness, mourn - ing 'neath their sor - rows' load. bid - ding all to full re - pen - tance since the king - dom now is here. Let your hearts be true and hum - ble, as be - fits God's ho - ly reign.' The third system continues: 'Speak un - to Je - ru - sa - lem of the peace that waits for them. O that warn - ing cry o - bey! Now pre - pare for God a way. For the glo - ry of the Lord now o'er earth is shed a - broad.' The fourth system concludes the piece: 'Tell of all the sins I cov - er, and that war - fare now is o - ver. Let the val - leys rise to meet God and the hills bow down to greet God. And all flesh shall see the to - ken that God's word is nev - er bro - ken.' The score ends with a double bar line.

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2 Hark, the voice of one who's cry - ing in the des - ert far and near,
3 O make straight what long was crook - ed, make the rough - er plac - es plain.

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